wave function would not interact, and did so in a much more detailed way than Everett ever had. Zeh's approach to these interactions was later dubbed "decoherence."

Zeh excitedly wrote up his account of decoherence and the universal wave function, but he wasn't sure where to turn for feedback on his work. "Of course, I could not say such ideas to colleagues," Zeh said. "They would [say] 'hey, you're completely crazy,' they would not accept even to think about that." Zeh instead took his work to his mentor, J. Hans Jensen, a Nobel Prize–winning physicist who had supervised Zeh's PhD at Heidelberg several years earlier. But Jensen was no expert on the quantum theory of measurement, so he sent the paper to a friend of his who knew more about the subject: Léon Rosenfeld, Bohr's former right-hand man and rabid defender of the Copenhagen interpretation. Rosenfeld, who had been insulting to Bohm and dismissive of Everett, was no kinder to Zeh. "I established a rule in my life never to step on anybody's toe," he wrote to Jensen, "but a preprint written by a certain 'Toe' [Zeh, in German] from your institute that I have received makes me digress from that rule. I have all the reasons in the world to assume that such a concentrate of wildest nonsense is not being distributed around the world with your blessing, and I think to be of service to you by directing your attention to this misfortune." Zeh knew Jensen had written to Rosenfeld, but not what Rosenfeld had said in reply. "I knew there was an answer, but Jensen never showed it to me," Zeh said. "But he showed [Rosenfeld's letter] to some other colleagues, and I noticed them chuckle about that. But for me it was very strange. I knew that there must have been some very negative comments, but I didn't even know what they [were]." Shortly thereafter, Jensen told Zeh that further work on the subject would extinguish his academic career. After that, Zeh said, "our relationship deteriorated."

Zeh was a polite man, but a stubborn one. After Rosenfeld's disastrous letter to Jensen, Zeh decided to submit his paper to several research journals anyhow. It didn't go well. One journal rejected it with a short note, stating that "the paper is completely senseless. It is clear that the author has not fully understood the problem and the previous contributions in this field." Another claimed that "quantum theory does not apply to macroscopic objects." And some journals just politely declined to publish it, with no reason given. In desperation, Zeh sent his paper off to one of the few